

Weekly Briefing — Issue #4

Everything that mattered in AI this week, and what you should do about it.

Week of Jun 8 – Jun 14, 2026 | Prepared for Jaroslaw

The 60-second version

- **The week in one idea: subtract the middle layer.** Almost every play this week *removed* something you used to need — a JS library, a backend server, a desktop tool, an export-to-spreadsheet loop, a runaway AI bill. The browser, the platform default, and the user's own machine quietly absorbed the work. The operator move: take the subtraction, but keep one guard.
- **Design + Dev — the browser ate the JavaScript (and the backend).** In one week: dividers in grid/flex (row-rule), staggered motion (sibling-index()), page transitions (View Transitions), an accessible carousel (CSS Overflow 5), and **real Python in the browser with no server** (Pyodide + WASM wheels on PyPI). Most are Chromium-only and degrade cleanly — ship as progressive enhancement.
- **AI tooling — the bill came under the microscope.** Cloudflare shipped dollar **spend caps** for AI calls; Claude **Fable 5** went GA but with a 30-day retention catch (ZDR doesn't apply); Claude Code **/workflows** made multi-agent orchestration a built-in; and the **Agent SDK billing split** lands Jun 15. Theme: govern AI spend and provenance, don't just consume it.
- **Marketing — answer engines are now a measurable channel.** AEO got its missing half: Semrush's **free AI Search Visibility Checker** scores whether ChatGPT/Gemini cite you; new research pinned the formats that win citations (and FAQ schema as an under-used edge); LinkedIn is the **#2 most-cited domain** in AI answers (original 500–2,000-word articles win). Paid: Google's DSA→AI Max migration slipped to Feb 2027 (a window to test), Meta's Opportunity Score went universal.
- **News — the AI trade got graded, then bounced.** A Broadcom guidance miss rotated money out of AI chips (Jun 3–8), then names snapped back (Jun 11) on reaffirmed ~\$750B hyperscaler capex; **SpaceX** ran the largest IPO in history (Musk → first trillionaire); and the **Fable 5 / Mythos 5** government suspension hardened. The durable read: capital is grading AI *spend*, not AI *ambition* — and power/compute is still the moat.
- **Sharpen your edge:** the connective thread to last week's 'controls collapse' — this week you also got to *remove* cost and dependencies, not just hand work to a default. Every subtraction below ships with a guard: a graceful CSS fallback, a spend cap, a data-retention check, a sandbox account. Take the simplification; keep the guardrail.

The week in one idea: subtract the middle layer

The wins this week were removals, not additions

Line the week's plays up and they rhyme: a CSS rule replaced a JS carousel library and a tooltip library; the browser itself ran Python so there was no backend to host (Pyodide + WASM wheels on PyPI); an MCP connector replaced the export-to-spreadsheet loop in your ESP; a single threshold replaced a manual upsell; a spend cap replaced the fear of a runaway bill. The middle layer — the dependency, the server, the manual workflow, the agency step — kept getting deleted because the browser, the platform default, or the user's own device absorbed it.

Synthesis, not recap: five-plus dailies this week told one story from different crafts — the cheapest, most durable win right now is a subtraction.

But every subtraction shipped with a guard

The discipline is the twin of the simplification. Push Python to the browser — but lazy-load it so you don't tax the page. Drop the tooltip library — but only because the native trio is now Baseline (test the keyboard). Let the platform default run your ads/agents — but keep a manual control, a spend cap, and a data-provenance check. The same week the market punished loose AI spend and Anthropic split Agent SDK billing, the move that wins is the one we keep repeating: take the default, keep one guardrail that catches a silent failure.

Do this: This week's homework, one line each: ship one Baseline native overlay and delete its JS (design); lazy-load one in-browser tool instead of a backend (dev); claim + cap your Agent SDK credit before Jun 15 (AI); run the free AI-visibility check and fix the top gap page (growth); re-peg one free-shipping threshold to current AOV (cro/marketing).

What changed, and what to do — by domain

One tight synthesis per domain that moved this week. The throughline (subtract + guard) shows up differently in each.

Web design — the browser replaced the JS library, five times

[\[web-design\]](#)

A remarkable run of native primitives landed or matured: Gap Decorations (column-rule/row-rule in grid & flex, Chrome 149), sibling-index()/sibling-count() for staggered motion and math layouts, the View Transitions API for app-like page changes, and CSS Overflow 5 carousel primitives — plus the Popover + invoker-commands + anchor-positioning trio that is now Baseline cross-browser. Each deletes a library or a hack.

Do this: Adopt the gracefully-degrading ones now as progressive enhancement (most are Chromium-only and fall back cleanly). Lead with the **Baseline** trio for production overlays (tooltips/menus) since it's safe for all users; keep the Chromium-only ones (carousel, sibling-index) decorative until a 2nd engine ships.

Keeper principle reaffirmed: a gracefully-degrading CSS primitive can ship the day it hits one engine; a Baseline one can replace a JS dependency outright.

Web dev — own less server: push compute to the edge and the browser

[\[web-dev\]](#)

The dev plays all moved work off your infrastructure: **Pyodide 314** + WASM wheels on PyPI run real Python (and its libraries) in a browser tab with no backend and no per-call API bill; **Copilot CLI + LSP** gave the terminal agent real code intelligence so it stops guessing; Vercel's Workflow SDK runs durably on Nitro v3. The security flip side: 'opening' a poisoned repo inside an AI IDE is now code execution — patch kernels, rotate tokens.

Do this: Reach for an in-browser tool (Pyodide) before standing up a backend for client-side calculators/explorers — lazy-load it on click. Wire LSP into your terminal agent. And treat your AI coding toolchain as attack surface: rotate any tokens exposed to untrusted repos.

Two independent dev cards this week (browser-Python, Copilot LSP) share one root: remove the layer that was only there to compensate for a missing capability.

AI tooling — govern the spend and the provenance

[\[ai-tooling\]](#)

The AI plays were about control, not capability: Cloudflare AI Gateway **spend limits** (a hard dollar cap), Claude Code **workflows** (planner→worker→verifier as a built-in primitive), and the **Table 5** GA with a 30-day retention catch (existing ZDR agreements don't apply; Microsoft restricted it internally). The **Agent SDK billing split** (Jun 15) makes cost governance a dated, required action.

Do this: Stand up the two-gate habit: a spend cap in front of every AI feature, and a data-provenance check before routing client-confidential data to any new model/default. Claim + cap the Agent SDK credit today. Keep a model router so a billing or retention change never single-points your pipeline.

This is last week's 'controls collapse → govern the system' continuing — but the week's sharpest edge was specifically about *money and data terms*, the two things that age your stack overnight.

Growth — answer engines became a measurable channel

[\[growth\]](#)

AEO stopped being vibes: Semrush's **free AI Search Visibility Checker** (no login) scores whether ChatGPT/Gemini/Perplexity cite you and lists the prompts where you're invisible; HubSpot/Wix research pinned which formats win citations; FAQ/structured-data schema emerged as an under-used legibility edge (~2.8× citation rate for well-structured pages). This resolved our open call that AEO would go mainstream-measurable (■).

Do this: Run the free check on a client domain, take the top 'invisible' prompt, and apply the formatting pass (intent title → one-sentence answer → list/table → original stat → FAQ schema + last-updated). Re-measure in 2–4 weeks.

Measure → fix → re-measure is now a real loop, not a leap of faith — the half that was missing in earlier AEO advice.

Social + Paid — design your inputs for the signal the AI now ranks on

[social · paid · meta-ads · google-ads]

Social: **LinkedIn** is the #2 most-cited domain in AI answers (original 500–2,000-word articles, posted consistently, beat viral feed posts), and Instagram's '**Your Algorithm**' topic controls reached the main feed — so a clean, consistent topic signal is the new reach lever. Paid: Meta's **Opportunity Score** went universal (a 0–100 setup-health grade) and the Advantage+ learning bar halved to ~25 conv/week; Google delayed the **DSA→AI Max** forced migration to Feb 2027 — a window to test AI Max as a guarded experiment, not get auto-migrated blind.

Do this: Social: publish one 500–2,000-word LinkedIn article answering a buyer's AI question; name one clear topic per Instagram post. Paid: triage accounts by Opportunity Score (fix anything under ~60), and run AI Max 50/50 against your live DSA in Experiments with brand exclusions pre-set before Feb 2027.

Same move as the AEO story: the platform automates the optimization; your edge is setting the inputs and the guardrails so its automation lands on your terms.

Graphic — make AI output editable and on-brand by declaring it as data

[graphic]

Two plays killed the worst failure modes of AI design assets: **Ideogram 4.0** takes a structured JSON brief (typed text layers, per-element bounding boxes, hex palette) so in-image text comes out spelled right and laid out where you put it; **Recraft V4 Vector** outputs true editable SVG (not a flat PNG) you drop into Figma and recolour to brand tokens.

Do this: For any AI logo/icon/layout headed for client work, prompt as a brief (declare copy, position, brand hexes) and demand a vector/editable output — then do a designer's pass for path cleanliness and licensing.

The graphic version of the week's theme: stop fighting the tool's defaults — hand it structured intent and get back something you can actually edit.

Email — query your live program in plain English, and own the inbox

[email]

Omnisend shipped a hosted **MCP server** — connect it to Claude and audit campaigns/deliverability against your real account without exports; and the durable **DMARC + BIMi** setup (one afternoon of DNS) improves inbox placement and puts your verified logo beside every send.

Do this: Connect the Omnisend MCP and ask for a 30-day revenue + deliverability audit with one fix each; separately, publish DMARC (move toward p=reject) and a BIMi record with a VMC.

MCP is the 'subtract the middle layer' move for marketers — the spreadsheet export loop disappears.

Techniques & tools worth adopting this week — the keepers

The survivors after killing 95%. Each is a run-it-today play with a real link.

The shortlist

[technique]

Keeper	What it buys you	Start here
Native overlay trio (Baseline)	Tooltips/menus/dropdowns with no JS library, for ALL browsers	popover + commandfor + anchor-name
Pyodide in the browser	Real Python tools with no backend or API bill; data never leaves the device	One CDN script + micropip, lazy-loaded
Cloudflare AI Gateway spend caps	A hard dollar ceiling so an AI feature can't run away	Proxy LLM calls → set spend limit
Claude Code /workflows	Planner→worker→verifier multi-agent runs as a built-in	Phrase a big job + 'use a workflow'
Free AI Search Visibility Checker	See whether ChatGPT/Gemini cite you + where you're invisible	Semrush free tool, no login

Keeper	What it buys you	Start here
Free-shipping threshold + bar	Lift AOV by nudging basket size (re-peg for 2026)	~15–25% above current AOV

Predictions ledger — resolved & newly on the board

Resolved this week

- ■ **[growth] AEO goes mainstream-measurable** (made Jun 8) — Semrush shipped a free AI Search Visibility Checker (0–100 across ChatGPT/Gemini/Perplexity, no login) plus the AI Toolkit; Ahrefs has Brand Radar. (Honest note: some of this tooling predated the call, so it resolved early.)
- ■■ **[ai-tooling] MiniMax M3's SWE-Bench Pro 59 claim** (made Jun 6) — no independent reproduction surfaced by the due date; the durable lesson held: treat unverified benchmark claims as hypotheses with a verification date.

Newly on the board (logged this week, still open)

- **[web-dev]** The PyPI WebAssembly-wheel ecosystem passes ~100 packages (from 28 on Jun 13) — due ~end of Q3 2026.
- **[web-design]** The CSS Overflow 5 carousel pseudo-elements ship in a 2nd engine (Firefox/Safari), and `sibling-index()` likewise — both on the path to Baseline — due ~end of 2026.
- **[paid]** Google's revised DSA→AI Max timeline holds (new-DSA creation ends Jan 2027, auto-migration begins Feb 2027) — due ~Feb 2027.
- **[social]** Plain-language topic controls spread to a 2nd major feed (YouTube/Threads/TikTok) or Instagram exposes inferred topics to creators — due ~end of 2026.
- **[news]** The Fable 5 / Mythos 5 government suspension is resolved — Anthropic restores access to at least one model as the directive lifts/clarifies — due ~Jul 11 2026.
- **[graphic]** A 2nd major image model ships native vector/SVG output (following Recraft V4) — due ~end of 2026.
- **[growth]** Schema/structured-data generation becomes a default feature of a major AEO tool (output, not just measurement) — due ~end of Q3 2026.

This week's action list

Concrete and assignable, per discipline.

- Design — Replace one tooltip/menu's JS with the Baseline native trio (popover + commandfor + anchor positioning) and test the keyboard.
- Dev — Prototype one client-side tool in the browser with Pyodide instead of a backend; lazy-load it on click.
- Dev — Put a Cloudflare AI Gateway spend cap in front of any LLM feature before it ships.
- AI/all — Claim your Agent SDK credit today (Jun 15), decide on usage-credit overflow, and cap it.
- AI/all — Keep a model router + 5-task frozen eval so a billing/retention change never single-points your pipeline.
- Growth — Run the free AI Search Visibility Checker on a client domain; fix the top 'invisible' page with the AEO formatting pass + FAQ schema.
- CRO — Show shipping/tax in the cart (kill the surprise) and re-peg the free-shipping threshold to ~15–25% above current AOV.
- Social — Publish one 500–2,000-word LinkedIn article answering a buyer's AI question; name one topic per Instagram post.
- Paid — Triage accounts by Meta Opportunity Score (fix under ~60); run AI Max 50/50 vs live DSA in Experiments before Feb 2027.
- Graphic/Email — Prompt AI design as a JSON/vector brief for editable output; connect the Omnisend MCP and run a 30-day audit.

Sources

web.dev — Popover API Baseline · MDN — CSS anchor positioning · Pyodide — 314.0 (WASM wheels on PyPI) · Cloudflare — AI Gateway spend limits · Anthropic — Agent SDK with your Claude plan (Jun 15 billing) · Anthropic — Fable 5 / Mythos 5 access statement · Semrush — free AI Search Visibility Checker · Semrush — LinkedIn AI-citation study · HubSpot — Schema markup for AEO · Search Engine Journal — Google extends DSA migration deadline (→AI Max, Feb 2027) · Baymard — cart abandonment (CRO) · CNBC — SpaceX record IPO / Musk first trillionaire

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